Chapter 11: NUST Code of Conduct

General

1. NUST is a leading research-intensive university in Pakistan comparable to the top universities of the world. The University is committed to its mission of graduating culturally enlightened, technologically knowledgeable, academically competent, and research-oriented productive citizens, groomed to lead, inspire, and serve humanity. The University is wholeheartedly pursuing her sublime trust and responsibility with all its resources.

2. NUST community comprises a diverse populace of students in pursuit of academic excellence. It strives to refine the ability of students to reason and to communicate freely and clearly on their way to becoming responsible, morally sound, moderate, and well-rounded citizens of a diverse world. The University expects these attributes to be reflected in the students' everyday behaviour, attitude, and attire.

3. In the University's view, the prescribed sets of regulations, guidelines, and safeguards described in this chapter are necessary to create and sustain an academic environment in sync with the teaching, learning, and developmental endeavours of the university community.

4. **Definition of Terms.**

   a. 'Complainant' means a person who makes a complaint or reports a violation of the University Code of Conduct or University regulations and policies.

   b. 'Intentional' means deliberate.

   c. 'Respondent' means a person who has been accused of violating the University Code of Conduct.

   d. 'Student' means any currently enrolled person for whom the institution maintains educational records, as defined by the University regulations.

   e. 'Reckless' means careless or heedless of the potentially harmful consequences of one's behaviour, where the risk of harm to persons, property, or normal University operations exists or can be reasonably foreseen.

   f. 'University Official' is a person employed by the University on an administrative, supervisory, academic, research, or support staff position.

5. **Academic Dishonesty.** Academic dishonesty is an act of fraud, which may include misrepresentation, deceit, falsification, or trickery of any kind committed by the student with the purpose, intent, or expectation of influencing a grade or other academic evaluation. Academic dishonesty also includes forgery and falsification of University academic documents, intentionally impeding or damaging the academic work of others, or assisting other students in acts of dishonesty. Common examples of academically dishonest behaviour include, but are not limited, to the following:

a. **Cheating**. Intentionally using or attempting to use unauthorized materials, information, or study aids in any academic exercise; copying from another student's examination; submitting work prepared in advance for an in-class examination; taking an examination for another person or conspiring to do so.

b. **Fabrication**. Intentional and unauthorized falsification or intervention of any information or citation in an academic exercise.

c. **Facilitating Academic Dishonesty**. Intentionally or knowingly helping or attempting to help another to commit an act of academic dishonesty.

d. **Plagiarism**. Intentionally or knowingly representing the words or ideas of another as one's own in any academic exercise; failure to attribute direct quotation, paraphrase, or borrowed facts or information.

e. **Unauthorized Collaboration.** Providing, either knowingly or through negligence, one's own work to assist a student in satisfying a course requirement, or representing material prepared by or with another as one's own independent work. In instances where students are permitted to work jointly to complete an assignment, teachers will offer clear guidelines about when and how to collaborate; if a student is unsure, it is the responsibility of the student to ask the faculty member.

6. **Unfair Means.** Use of unfair means generally covers the following:

a. An attempt to have access to the question paper before the test/examination.

b. Use/possession of unauthorized reference material during a test/examination.

c. Any form of communication by the student with anyone in or outside the test/examination venue while the test/examination is in progress.

d. Unauthorized entry into faculty's office or that of his/her staff with the intention of having access to or tampering with the official record/examination paper etc.

7. **Moral Dishonesty.** Moral dishonesty means an act that does not conform to known norms of decency.

8. **Conduct.**

a. **Application of NUST Code of Conduct.** NUST Code of Conduct applies to the conduct displayed on the University premises, at NUST sponsored activities, and to off-campus conduct that adversely affects the University's reputation and/or the pursuit of its objectives. Each member of NUST shall be responsible for his/her conduct.

b. **Classroom Standards.** The individual faculty member is primarily responsible for managing the classroom environment. If a student engages in any prohibited or unlawful act or other behaviour that results in disruption of a class, he or she may be directed by the faculty member to leave the class for the remainder of the class duration. Students must be protected against infringement of their rights and unfair practices.

c. **Identification/Registration Card**

(1) Each member of the University community is issued a picture identification/registration card or visitor's pass, which must be always worn while on University premises or at University-sponsored activities. Identification/registration cards must be presented upon entering University buildings.

(2) Identification/registration cards are not transferable. The owner of the card will be called upon to account for any fraudulent use of his/her identification card and will be subject to disciplinary action by the University if he or she has aided such fraudulent use. The card will be forfeited if the student to whom it was issued allows any other person to use it.

(3) Upon a card owner's withdrawal from the University, all rights and privileges related to the identification card automatically cease. If the student withdraws or is suspended or expelled from the University, the identification card must be surrendered to the institution.

9. **Visitors & Guests.** Students may be held accountable for the acts of misconduct of their guests during their presence on University premises or at University-sponsored activities. Visitors, including guests, shall conduct themselves, at all times, in a manner consistent with orderly behaviour on a University campus.

10. **Discipline Matters.** The University is a place where the students have imparted education not only as a means to obtain a degree but also to develop their personalities and to enrich the society of which they are members. Therefore, disciplined and organized life on the campus is extremely important. It is essential to lay down rules and regulations to create and sustain an orderly and decent atmosphere on the premises of NUST constituent institutions. It is with this objective that Discipline Committees have been formed on all NUST campuses. The heads of the institutions are empowered to award minor punishments, on the recommendations of respective Discipline Committees, to students found guilty of misconduct. Major punishments for civilian students shall be awarded by Rector on the recommendations of NUST Discipline Committee. However, military procedures shall continue to govern military students selected by the Services.

11. **Discipline Committee.**

a. NUST Discipline Committee shall consist of:

(1) Chairman to be nominated by Rector

(2) One senior faculty member from each constituent institution is to be nominated by the head of the institution, subject to a maximum of five

(3) Students' representative from the concerned institution

(4) Officer in charge of Student Affairs from Main Office NUST – to be a member

(5) Any other member co-opted by the Discipline Committee

b. The Institution Discipline Committee shall consist of:

(1) Deputy Commandant/Vice-Principal/ Dean - Chairman

(2) Three Professors/Associate Professors nominated by Commandant/ Principal

(3) Students' representative by rotation

c. The Discipline Committee shall award punishment or penalty for a breach of discipline on the campus after giving the defaulter full opportunity to give his/her viewpoint.

d. The term of office of the Committee other than ex-officio members shall be two years.

e. The quorum for the meeting of the NUST Discipline Committee shall be five.

f. During an academic session, the Discipline Committee shall meet at least every two months or whenever required.

12. **Acts of Ill-discipline/Prohibited Conduct.** All students are prohibited from engaging in conduct resulting in, or leading to, any of the following:

a. **Academic Dishonesty.** Academic dishonesty encompasses all cases of violations of the University Policy on Academic Dishonesty by committing, or attempting to commit, academic dishonesty including, but not limited to, cheating, plagiarism, fabrication, facilitating academic dishonesty to others, and unauthorized collaboration.

b. **Abuse, Assault, Threatening Behaviour.** These include intentionally or reckless acts endangering, threatening, or causing physical or mental harm to any person, or oneself, on University premises or at University-sponsored activities, or intentionally or causing reasonable apprehension of such harm including, but not limited to abusive language and/or physical or verbal intimidation, harassment, coercion.

c. **Firearms, Explosives, and Other Weapons.** Use/possession of hazardous materials (biological/chemical) and any type of weapons, firearms, explosives, crackers, etc.

d. **Violation of Disciplinary Sanction.** This means knowingly violating the terms of any disciplinary sanction imposed in accordance with NUST Statutes.

e. **Furnishing False Information, Forgery, or Unauthorized Use of Documents.** Intentionally furnishing false information to the University and its officials; or misusing affiliation with the University to gain access to outside agency/services, or using false information or University resources to compromise the name of the University. Forgery, unauthorized alteration, or unauthorized use of any University document or electronic transmission, or instrument of identification, or academic and non-academic records, signatures, seals, or stamps thereof.

f. **Disorderly Conduct or Indecent Behaviour.** Engaging in disorderly or indecent conduct; breaching of peace; or aiding, abetting, or luring another person to breach the peace on University premises or at University-sponsored functions/activities. Any unauthorized use of electronic or other devices to make an audio or video record of any person while on University premises without his/her prior knowledge/permission.

g. **Theft.** Theft, or attempted theft, of property or services on University premises or at University-sponsored activities.

h. **Damage to Property or its Destruction.** Intentionally or recklessly destroying or damaging, or attempting to destroy or damage, University property or the property of others on University premises or at University-sponsored activities.

i. **Non-Compliance with Official Direction.** Failure to comply with **a** reasonable direction of University officials acting in the performance of their duties.

j. **Violation of University Regulations and Policies.** Violating University regulations or policies including amendments and additions adopted since the date of publication.

k. **Drugs/Narcotics.** Direct/Indirect use/sale/possession/facilitation/distribution of drugs, narcotics, intoxicants, etc. on the campus.

l. **Unauthorized Access to Facilities.** Unauthorized access or entry to, or use of, University facilities and equipment. Unauthorized possession, duplication, or use of keys to any University premises, facilities, or equipment; or, unauthorized entry to or use of University premises.

m. **Unauthorized Use of Computer or Electronic Communication Devices.** Theft or other abuse of computer facilities and resources including, but not limited to:

(1) unauthorized access to a file, with the intention of using, reading, or changing the contents, or for any other purpose;

(2) unauthorized transfer of a file;

(3) use of another individual's identification and/or password;

(4) interference with the work of another student, faculty member, or University official;

(5) sending obscene, abusive, or threatening messages;

(6) transmission of computer viruses;

(7) interfering with the normal operation of the University computing system;

(8) unauthorized duplication of software or other violation of copyright laws;

(9) unauthorized access to, or unauthorized, mischievous or malicious use of University computer equipment or networks, or electronic communication devices, or the use of such equipment or devices to gain unauthorized access to, and/or use of, off-campus computer equipment;

(10) indulgence in misuse of internet and cyber offences i.e., uploading of objectionable content leading to provocation or maligning anyone.

n. **Provoking Others to Misconduct.** Intentionally using words or actions to incite or encourage others to violent or retaliatory behaviour, or other acts of misconduct.

o. **Identification/Registration Cards**. Failure to wear, or to produce or surrender the identification card upon the request of a University official.

p. **Animals.** Bringing an animal into any University building, except for the animals used for authorized laboratory purposes, animals being used for security purposes, or service animals (e.g., guide dogs for the visually impaired) for which express permission has been granted.

q. **Demonstrations**. Demonstrations exceeding the bounds of free assembly and demonstrations engaging in unlawful acts that cause or imminently threaten injury to person or property infringes on the rights of other members of the University community leading to or inciting others to disrupt scheduled and/or normal activities within any campus building or area.

r. **Political/Sectarian Activities.** Indulgence in political/ethnic/racial/sectarian activities or taking membership of any banned organization and participation in such like organizations for furthering the cause of a political party.

s. **Harassment**. It covers the following:

(1) Passing remarks, placing visual or written material, aimed at a specific person or group:

(a) with the intention of causing harm to the person or group; and/or,

(b) creating an environment that limits a student's educational opportunity.

(2) Making unwanted verbal or physical advances or explicit derogatory statements toward individuals, that cause them discomfort or humiliation, or that interfere with their educational opportunity.

(3) Physical assault

t. **Gambling.** Unauthorized and/or illegal exchange of money favours or services as a result of an organized or unorganized game or competition.

u. **Smoking.** NUST H-12 campus has been declared green campus therefore, smoking is prohibited on University premises for which a policy directive has been issued.

v. **Abuse of the Student Conduct System.** Abusing the student conduct system includes, but is not limited to:

(1) failure to obey the notice from a University official to appear for a meeting or hearing as part of the student conduct system;

(2) falsification, distortion, or misrepresentation of information before a hearing body or designated hearing officer of the University;

(3) disruption or interference with the orderly conduct of a hearing proceeding;

(4) causing a violation of the University Code of Conduct hearing to convene in bad faith.

w. **Public Display of Affection (PDA).** Indecent behaviour exhibited on the campus including classes, cafeteria, laboratories, etc., defying the norms of decency, morality, and religious/cultural/social values by an individual or a group of students. Public Display of Affection (PDA) is an act of physical intimacy carried out in public. It involves physical contact including, but not limited to, caressing, hugging, fondling, kissing, etc. Any act of sexual connotation including but not limited to physical intimacy (hugging, intimate kissing, caressing, fondling, sitting in each other's lap, etc.) for same-sex/opposite-sex in University premises/events/activities/excursion trips, etc. is to be avoided regardless. Any lax in this context will lead to disciplinary action based upon the identified penalties.

x. **Public Interaction.** In continuation to clause 12w, during University interactions, students (opposite-sex/same-sex) are further expected to maintain decent physical distance (arm's length), and to avoid sitting in each other's lap, lying next to each other, etc., in University premises / events /

activities / Excursion trips, etc. Any failing in this regard will lead to disciplinary action based upon the penalties as per NUST Regulations.

y. Damage to the University fixtures/furniture, scribbling/carving on desks, wall chalking, misusing of lab/university equipment, etc.

z. The use of mobile phones in classrooms, examination halls, labs, and libraries thus disrupting the calm environment of such places.

13. **Off-Campus Conduct.** Conduct occurring off-University premises be such that it should not affect the interest/image of the University.

14. **Enforcement of Code of Conduct.** Matters of indiscipline would be referred to the concerned institution or NUST authorities authorized to check discipline matters and decide on them in line with NUST policy, rules, and regulations. Parents of those students who disobey authority and violate the code of conduct will be informed. Students may be held accountable for the acts of misconduct of their guests while on University premises or at University-sponsored activities. Students who are charged with violations of this Code are subject to disciplinary action in accordance with NUST rules/regulations/statutes.

15. **Punishment or Penalty for Acts of Ill-Discipline.** Punishment or penalty for acts of ill-discipline shall be according to the gravity of the case and may be any one or more of the following:

a. **Minor Punishments**

(1) **Warning in Writing.** Notice to the offender, orally or in writing, that continuation or repetition of prohibited conduct may lead to further disciplinary action.

(2) **Probation.** Probation for a specific period.

(3) **Fine.** Fine amounting up to Rs 10,000.

(4) **Hostel Suspension/Permanent Removal.** Expulsion from the hostel for a specified period, or permanent removal from the residence hall.

(5) **Withholding of Certificate.** Withholding of a certificate of good moral character.

(6) **Removal of Privileges.** Deprivation from the privileges enjoyed by the student.

(7) Expulsion from the hostel for a period of up to one semester.

(8) **F Grade.** Award of **F** grade in a course of studies.

b. **Major Punishments**

(1) **Expulsion.** Expulsion from the class for a specific period up to one semester.

(2) **Fine.** This may amount to up to Rs 50,000.

(3) **Exam Result.** Cancellation of examination results (complete semester courses).

(4) **Rustication**. Expulsion or rustication from the institution for a specific period.

(5) **Degree**. Non-conferment of degree / transcript.

(6) **Relegation / withdrawal**

16. Other sanctions or a combination of the above-mentioned punishments as deemed appropriate.

17. **Disciplinary Process.**

a. **Case Referrals.** Each case of ill-discipline shall be reported to the head of the institution through HOD or the manager hostel. Any charge should be submitted as soon as possible after the occurrence of the alleged violation, preferably within 24 hours of the violation. Those referring cases are normally expected to serve as complainants and to present relevant evidence in disciplinary hearings before the NUST/Institution Discipline Committee. Depending on the gravity of the case, the head of the institution will decide to award minor punishment at the institution level or refer the matter to NUST Discipline Committee for decision by the competent authority for major punishment.

b. **Hearing of Disciplinary Cases.** A disciplinary hearing is a formal process conducted by the Institution Discipline Committee. This formal process is designed to gather and consider relevant information regarding the alleged violation/s of the Code and to determine and recommend a punishment. Every effort will be made to expedite proceedings pursuant to allegations within a reasonable period.

c. **Punishments.** NUST/Institution Discipline Committee will recommend the punishment according to the gravity of the case after giving the defaulter full opportunity to give his/her point of view. This must be done before recommending the punishment to the head of the institution/Rector.

d. **Appeals.** An appeal against the decision of the Discipline Committee can be filed with the head of the institution/Rector within fifteen days of the announcement of the decision.

18. **Federal/Provincial Laws and Ordinances.** Violation of a Federal/Provincial law or ordinance will be dealt with accordingly under these laws.

19. **Littering**. It is the responsibility of all to keep the Campus environment clean and tidy. No littering or trash should be carelessly thrown or left on the Campus premises. The designated waste boxes should be used for trash disposal.

20. **Sports.** All individuals and teams involved in sports are expected to show sportsmanship, respect, consideration, and appreciation towards their opponents, teammates, officials, and University staff at all times.

a. Under no circumstances should a player or sportsperson react violently nor use any form of foul or abusive language, whether it is directed at a member of staff, match official, opponent, playing colleague, team official, or spectators.

b. By signing the player registration form, individuals agree to abide by the code of conduct and will accept that any deviation from these rules will result in disciplinary action by the University.

c. Persons under the influence of drugs are not permitted to participate in sports activities at the University and as such the defaulters shall be liable to disciplinary action by NUST.

d. On a final note, please remember that no referee, umpire, or official is perfect. You may not agree with every decision that is made and, just like players, the umpires and sports officials too may make mistakes.

21. **Dress Code.** Clothes should not distract from the learning environment or be considered inappropriate in a business or professional setting and attract undue attention. Examples of inappropriate clothing include:

a. see-through or revealing garments, backless dresses, skinny fitted clothes, leggings/tights;

b. casual footwear (e.g., flip flops/bedroom slippers);

c. short pants/short skirts, knickers/shorts;

d. clothing with derogatory, offensive and/or lewd messages either in words or pictures, or any piece of clothing promoting racism, violence, sex, drugs, alcohol, or other illegal activities;

e. dressing in culturally inappropriate clothes to emphasize body parts (both for male/females) may qualify as an example of Sexual Harassment by hurting/disrespecting human feelings and emotions of others;

f. any failing in this regard will lead to disciplinary action based upon the identified penalties as per NUST Regulations.

22. **Greetings**. Students are advised to adopt the habit of exchange of formal culturally appropriate/Islamic greetings i.e., Assalam-o-Alaikum / Wa Alaikum Assalam while meeting